

h1 { color: #7a5230; font-size: 20pt; } h2 { color: #7a5230; font-size: 11pt; } h3 { color: #333333; font-size: 10pt; } p, li { font-size: 9pt; color: #1a1a1a; } th { background-color: #7a5230; color: #ffffff; font-size: 8pt; } td { border: 0.4px solid #d8d2c8; font-size: 8.5pt; } blockquote { color: #444444; font-size: 8.5pt; } code { font-family: DejaVuMono; font-size: 8pt; }

DESIGN CODE NS 09

Shelby the Sea Turtle Bag Charm

US crochet terms · Easy · 30 minutes · market bestseller

A pocket sea turtle on a keyring — the classic craft-market impulse buy. Under half an hour, a couple of grams of yarn, and the flippers and head are worked straight into the shell so there is almost nothing to sew.

SAFETY — READ THIS FIRST

Shelby has **two 4 mm safety eyes**. Safety eyes are small parts. Lock the washers firmly from the inside and pull-test each one — a properly locked washer will not come off by hand.

This pattern has not been tested to a toy-safety standard such as ASTM F963 or EN 71. Shelby is sold as a keyring and bag charm; if you also market it as a **pocket toy**, please do not describe it as "baby-safe" or "suitable from birth". For a child under three, use **French knots** rather than safety eyes.

The keyring is the other hazard: attach it through **two** stitches and knot the yarn inside the shell. A charm that comes off a bag is a small part with a metal ring on it.

MATERIALS

Shell yarn — DK / light worsted (#3) cotton, about **1 g**. Sage, teal, mustard or rust.

Body yarn — DK cotton, about **1 g** in a contrast cream, sand or pale green.

The whole charm is 203 stitches, which is roughly 3 m of DK. Two grams covers it with room for the embroidery and the tails; the rest of a ball makes the next ten charms.

Hook — 2.5 mm (US C-2).

Eyes — 2 × 4 mm safety eyes, or two small black French knots. See the note in section 4 — at this size the knots are the easier fit.

Also needed — A pinch of polyfill (well under 1 g); tapestry needle; one 25 mm keyring or lobster clasp per turtle.

GAUGE & FINISHED SIZE

Gauge — DK cotton on a 2.5 mm hook: about 3.5 mm per stitch and 3.2 mm per round.

Finished size — About **3.7 cm (1.5 in) across the flippers, 3.2 cm (1.25 in) long and 1.9 cm (0.75 in) deep**. Both the shell and the underside finish at 24 stitches, and 24 stitches at this gauge is a disc 26.7 mm across — that single number sets the size of the whole charm. If you want a 6 cm charm, see **Making a bigger Shelby** at the end.

ABBREVIATIONS

MR magic ring · **sc** single crochet · **hdc** half double crochet · **inc** 2 sc in one stitch · **sl st** slip stitch · **BLO** back loop only · **FO** fasten off · **(n)** stitch count

Work in a continuous spiral — do not join between rounds. Mark the first stitch of every round.

CORE TECHNIQUES

These are the techniques Shelby uses, in the order you will meet them.

1 · THE MAGIC RING. Wrap the yarn once around two fingers, insert the hook, pull up a loop, work the first

round into the ring, then pull the tail tight.

2 • WORK IN A SPIRAL. Do not join and do not ch 1 between rounds. Keep a stitch marker in the first stitch of every round and move it up each time — there is no join to count from.

3 • BACK LOOP ONLY (BLO). Work into the far loop of the stitch only. The unused loops form a raised ridge — on the shell that ridge is the rim, and it is what makes the dome read as a shell rather than a bun.

4 • SEVERAL STITCHES INTO ONE STITCH (the cluster). This is the whole trick of the head and flippers. You work every stitch of the group into **one** stitch of the previous round, so they all share a single anchor and fan out into a bump that stands proud of the fabric. Each cluster consumes one stitch and produces as many stitches as it contains — that is why a round of 24 stitches can produce 35.

5 • WHIP STITCH. Pass the needle through both layers from back to front, then over the edge and back through, repeating. Keep the tension even or the join will pucker.

6 • FRENCH KNOTS. Bring the needle up, wrap the floss once or twice around the needle, then push the needle back down close to where it emerged and pull through slowly. Used for the eyes at this size.

1. SHELL — TOP

A shallow dome. The BLO round at Rnd 5 gives the shell its rim.

RND	INSTRUCTION	STS	NOTE
Rnd 1	6 sc in MR	(6)	
Rnd 2	inc in each st around	(12)	
Rnd 3	[sc, inc] ×6	(18)	
Rnd 4	[2 sc, inc] ×6	(24)	
Rnd 5	BLO sc around	(24)	rim ridge
Rnd 6	sc in each st around	(24)	

Finish. FO, leaving a 30 cm tail for joining.

Shell markings. Before joining, embroider five or six shallow V shapes in a darker shade across the dome. It takes two minutes and it is the difference between a turtle and a green blob.

2. UNDERSIDE — WITH HEAD AND FLIPPERS WORKED IN

Worked as a flat disc in the contrast color. The head and four flippers are worked directly into the final round, so there is nothing to sew on afterwards.

RND	INSTRUCTION	STS	NOTE
Rnd 1	6 sc in MR	(6)	
Rnd 2	inc in each st around	(12)	
Rnd 3	[sc, inc] ×6	(18)	
Rnd 4	[2 sc, inc] ×6	(24)	flat disc, matches the shell

Finish. Do not fasten off — work the head and flippers next.

3. HEAD & FLIPPERS — WORKED INTO RND 4 OF THE UNDERSIDE

Five bumps worked into the 24 stitches of the underside. Each bump takes one stitch, and the plain stitches between them space the limbs evenly.

RND	INSTRUCTION	STS	NOTE
Rnd 5	3 sc, (sc, hdc, hdc, sc) in next st, 4 sc, (sc, hdc, sc) in next st, 3 sc, (sc, hdc, sc) in next st, 4 sc, (35) hdc, sc) in next st, 3 sc, (sc, hdc, sc) in next st, 2 sc		head + 4 flippers

Finish. Sl st in the next stitch and FO, leaving a 20 cm tail.

The round consumes $3 + 1 + 4 + 1 + 3 + 1 + 4 + 1 + 3 + 1 + 2 = 24$ stitches, exactly closing the underside disc, and produces 35. The first bump — the four-stitch one — is the head; the four smaller bumps are the flippers.

The five bumps land on stitches 4, 9, 13, 18 and 22, which puts the two front flippers 75° and 90° either side of the head. That one-stitch difference is invisible at this size, but if you want them exact, work the last plain run as 3 sc instead of 2 and take one stitch from the run before the head.

4. FACE

Eyes — read this first. The head bump is four stitches worked into a single stitch, so it is a small loop only about 7–10 mm across, and a 4 mm safety eye needs a washer of roughly 6–7 mm. The washer often will not fit inside the bump, and two eyes 2 stitches apart (7 mm) sit right at its edges.

At this size, French knots are the better choice. Two small black knots, 2 stitches apart, low on the front of the head bump.

If you do want safety eyes, place them **1 stitch apart** and check the washer seats fully before you close the shell. Fix them **before** joining — once the shell is on you cannot reach inside.

5. JOINING AND FINISHING

1. Fix the eyes to the head bump before you close the turtle.

2. Hold the shell dome against the underside, wrong sides together, with the head bump pointing away from the shell's 30 cm tail.

3. Whip stitch the join using the shell's 30 cm tail. **Match 24 to 24, not 24 to 35.** The underside's outer round has 35 stitches, but they sit in only 24 anchor positions — 19 plain stitches plus the 5 clusters. Put one shell stitch against each anchor position, and where you come to a bump, pass the needle through the **base stitch the bump was worked into**, not through the bump's own stitches. The bumps will emerge from the join as the head and flippers.

4. Add a small pinch of stuffing when you are about three quarters of the way round. Do not overstuff — a bag charm should stay flat enough to sit against a bag, and the shell only holds about 8 cm³.

5. Weave in every end inside the shell.

6. Attach the keyring through two stitches at the back of the shell, opposite the head, and knot the yarn inside. Going through two stitches rather than one stops the ring from tearing out of the fabric with everyday use — this is the single most common failure on sold charms.

6. WHY THIS ONE SELLS AT MARKETS

Under 30 minutes, a couple of grams of yarn, and it hits three separate buying motives at once: keyring, bag charm and pocket toy.

Make them in batches of one color, not one at a time. Six shells, then six undersides, then six joins is roughly twice as fast as six complete turtles.

Price them as a small impulse buy and display them in a bowl at eye level rather than flat on the table. Offer a mixed-color multi-buy — most market sales are two or three at once, not one.

State the real size in your listing. Shelby is about 3.7 cm across the flippers. If you want the bigger charm, make the version below and list that one instead — do not list the small one as 6 cm.

MAKING A BIGGER SHELBY (about 5.7 cm across the flippers)

Same pattern, worked to 42 stitches instead of 24. This gives a charm about **5.7 cm across the flippers, 5.2 cm long and 2.9 cm deep** — allow 45–50 minutes and about 4 g of yarn.

Shell. Rnd 1: 6 sc in MR (6). Rnd 2: inc in each st around (12). Rnd 3: [sc, inc] ×6 (18). Rnd 4: [2 sc, inc] ×6 (24). Rnd 5: [3 sc, inc] ×6 (30). Rnd 6: [4 sc, inc] ×6 (36). Rnd 7: [5 sc, inc] ×6 (42). Rnd 8: BLO sc around (42). Rnd 9: sc in each st around (42). FO, 30 cm tail.

Underside. Rnd 1 to Rnd 7 exactly as the shell's Rnd 1 to Rnd 7, ending at 42 stitches. Do not fasten off.

Head and flippers.

RND	INSTRUCTION	STS	NOTE
Rnd 8	7 sc, (sc, hdc, hdc, sc) in next st, 8 sc, (sc, hdc, sc) in next st, 7 sc, (sc, hdc, sc) in next st, 8 sc, (sc, hdc, sc) in next st, 7 sc, (sc, hdc, sc) in next st (53)		head + 4 flippers

This consumes $7 + 1 + 8 + 1 + 7 + 1 + 8 + 1 + 7 + 1 = 42$ stitches, exactly closing the disc, and produces 53. The bumps land on stitches 8, 17, 25, 34 and 42, which spaces them 9, 8, 9, 8, 8 apart — closer to even than the small version. Join 42 to 42 by the same rule as step 3 above.

TROUBLESHOOTING

Flippers are uneven. Count the plain stitches between the bumps: 3, 4, 3, 4, 3, then 2 at the end.

Keyring pulls out. Attach it through two stitches, not one, and knot the yarn inside the shell.

Too fat to hang flat. Less stuffing. A charm needs just enough to hold the dome.

Shell and base do not match. Both must finish at 24 stitches. Check Rnd 4 on each piece.

The join will not pair up. You are counting the underside's 35 stitches. Count anchor positions instead: 19 plain stitches plus 5 bumps = 24.

Head is floppy. The head bump is the 4-stitch one. Work it into a single stitch so it stands proud.

THE FINISHED PROJECT

Shelby on a keyring — about 3.7 cm across the flippers.

Before you close the shell, check three things: the eyes are fixed and pull-tested, the five bumps are all present and the head is the four-stitch one, and the shell's rim and the underside's Rnd 4 both read 24 stitches.

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